

Communication Audit and Benchmark Analysis of IKEA (Spanish market)

Project: From Global Brand to Digital Culture Actor: A Social Media Communication Strategy for IKEA

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1. Introduction

Digital communication has become a key strategic tool for retail brands operating in highly competitive markets. Social media platforms enable companies not only to promote products but also to build brand identity, create communities, and participate in digital culture.

This section analyses the social media communication of IKEA in the Spanish market. The objective of this analysis is to evaluate the company's current digital presence and compare it with key competitors operating in the home and furniture sector.

The communication audit focuses on three main social media platforms used by IKEA Spain:

- Instagram
- TikTok
- YouTube

These platforms represent the core channels of IKEA's digital communication strategy and play an important role in shaping the brand's relationship with digital audiences.

The audit is complemented by a benchmark analysis with three key competitors in the Spanish home retail market:

- JYSK

- Leroy Merlin
- Maisons du Monde

The results of the analysis will help identify strategic communication gaps and determine the most relevant platform for the development of a future content strategy.

2. Communication Audit: IKEA Spain

2.1 Social Media Presence

IKEA Spain maintains a strong presence across several social media platforms, using digital communication to promote interior inspiration, showcase products, and build brand awareness.

The company has built a large social media community in Spain, reaching more than two million followers across its different social media channels.

Among the various platforms used by the brand, Instagram represents the most important communication channel. The account @ikeaspain has approximately two million followers and more than two thousand published posts.

In addition to Instagram, the brand is also active on TikTok and YouTube, which allow the company to experiment with video-based formats and reach younger audiences.

2.2 Instagram Communication Strategy

Instagram functions as the main visual platform for IKEA Spain's communication.

The content strategy on Instagram focuses primarily on:

- interior inspiration
- product promotion
- lifestyle storytelling

- seasonal collections

The visual style reflects the brand's Scandinavian design philosophy: minimalist aesthetics, practical solutions, and affordable design.

Instagram posts typically present fully styled interiors or highlight specific furniture solutions for small apartments, organization, or decoration.

However, the communication remains largely brand-centered, with relatively limited user interaction or participatory formats.

2.3 TikTok Communication Strategy

TikTok provides IKEA Spain with opportunities to experiment with more dynamic and informal communication formats.

Typical content includes:

- home decoration tips
- short interior transformations
- humorous everyday home situations
- product demonstrations

TikTok allows the brand to communicate in a more relatable and entertaining tone compared to the more polished visual storytelling seen on Instagram.

Despite this potential, the platform appears to be less developed compared to Instagram and therefore offers significant opportunities for strategic growth.

2.4 YouTube Communication Strategy

YouTube serves primarily as a platform for longer video content and campaign storytelling.

The channel includes content such as:

- advertising campaigns
- home inspiration videos
- product assembly tutorials
- short-form video content through YouTube Shorts

While YouTube provides opportunities for educational content and brand storytelling, the channel is used less frequently and does not appear to be a primary driver of community engagement.

3. Benchmark Analysis: Spanish Market Competitors

To better understand the communication positioning of IKEA Spain, it is necessary to compare its strategy with key competitors operating in the Spanish home and furniture market.

Three competitors have been selected for this benchmark analysis:

- JYSK
- Leroy Merlin
- Maisons du Monde

These companies represent different strategic approaches to home retail and digital communication.

3.1 JYSK

JYSK is a Danish furniture retailer that competes directly with IKEA in the affordable furniture segment.

The brand's communication strategy focuses strongly on:

- product promotions
- price discounts
- Scandinavian design aesthetics

Compared with IKEA, JYSK's communication is more transactional and promotion-oriented, with less emphasis on lifestyle storytelling.

3.2 Leroy Merlin Spain

Leroy Merlin is one of the leading home improvement retailers in Spain.

Its communication strategy differs significantly from IKEA because it focuses on DIY and home renovation.

Typical content includes:

- renovation tutorials
- home improvement advice
- step-by-step guides

This educational communication strategy positions Leroy Merlin as an expert brand in home improvement rather than interior design inspiration.

3.3 Maisons du Monde

Maisons du Monde operates in a slightly more premium segment of the furniture and decoration market.

The brand's communication focuses heavily on:

- aesthetic interior design
- curated furniture collections
- aspirational lifestyle imagery

Compared with IKEA, the brand positions itself as a more design-oriented and premium interior brand.

4. Benchmark Comparison

4.1 Quantitative Benchmark: Social Media Performance

To complement the qualitative benchmark analysis, it is useful to compare the digital performance indicators of IKEA Spain and its main competitors across the three key social media platforms.

Instagram Comparison

Instagram remains the most important platform for visual communication in the home and furniture sector.

Brand	Followers	Engagement rate	Content style
IKEA Spain	1.9M	0.07%	Interior inspiration
JYSK Spain	389K	0.12%	Promotions and offers
Leroy Merlin Spain	1.1M	0.06%	DIY inspiration
Maisons du Monde	2.6M	0.03%	Premium design aesthetics

Data taken from the trendhero.io website 08.03.2026

The data shows that Maisons du Monde currently has the largest audience among the analysed brands with approximately 2.6 million followers, followed by IKEA Spain with 1.9 million followers.

Despite having a slightly smaller audience, IKEA maintains a strong presence and continues to be one of the most visible brands on the platform.

In terms of engagement rate, JYSK Spain achieves the highest level (0.12%), which may be explained by its highly promotional content strategy that encourages direct consumer interaction.

Meanwhile, Leroy Merlin Spain and IKEA Spain show relatively similar engagement levels (0.06%–0.07%), reflecting the more informative and inspiration-based communication style used by these brands.

The relatively lower engagement rate of Maisons du Monde (0.03%) may be related to its significantly larger audience size, which often reduces relative engagement levels.

TikTok Comparison

TikTok has become an important platform for reaching younger audiences and increasing organic visibility through short-form video content.

Brand	Followers	Overall engagement	Avg. Views
IKEA Spain	212K	4.03%	450,498
Leroy Merlin Spain	408K	2.73%	10,748
JYSK	330K	0.98%	7,683
Maisons du Monde	121K	0.26%	228,887

Data taken from the countik.com website 08.03.2026

Among the competitors, IKEA Spain shows the strongest engagement performance, reaching an overall engagement rate of 4.03%, which is the highest in the benchmark.

Although Leroy Merlin Spain has the largest audience on TikTok (408K followers), its engagement rate (2.73%) is noticeably lower than IKEA's, suggesting that IKEA's content resonates more strongly with users on the platform.

The data also reveals significant differences in average views per video. IKEA Spain achieves the highest average reach (450,498 views per video), indicating strong algorithmic visibility and effective content distribution.

Interestingly, Maisons du Monde generates relatively high average views (228,887) despite having the smallest audience (60K followers), which may suggest occasional viral content performance.

In contrast, JYSK's TikTok performance appears weaker, with both lower engagement (0.98%) and lower average views.

These results highlight that TikTok offers strong organic reach potential, especially for brands that successfully adapt their content to short-form video formats.

YouTube Comparison

YouTube functions primarily as a platform for longer educational or campaign-based video content.

Estimated channel performance:

Brand	Subscribers	Avg. Views	Engagement Rate
IKEA Spain	191K	17K	0.58%
Leroy Merlin Spain	455K	55K	0.85%
Maisons du Monde	2.63K	198	1.65%

JYSK Spain	312	2.3K	0.43%
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Data taken from the ytimestamp.com website 08.03.2026

The data clearly shows that Leroy Merlin Spain dominates the platform, with 455K subscribers, significantly more than any other analysed brand.

This strong performance is likely linked to the company’s DIY-focused content strategy, which includes renovation tutorials and practical home improvement guides that align well with YouTube’s educational format.

IKEA Spain maintains a solid presence with 191K subscribers and an average of 17K views per video, indicating moderate but consistent audience engagement.

Interestingly, Maisons du Monde shows the highest engagement rate (1.65%), despite having a very small subscriber base (2.63K). This suggests that its content may be highly relevant to its niche audience.

In contrast, JYSK’s YouTube presence remains extremely limited, with only 312 subscribers, indicating that the platform is not currently a strategic priority for the brand.

Overall, the results confirm that YouTube functions primarily as a specialized platform for educational and instructional content, where brands with strong expertise-based content strategies perform best.

4.2 Cross-Brand Digital Presence

A combined comparison highlights the strategic positioning of each brand across platforms.

Brand	Instagram strength	TikTok growth	YouTube role
IKEA	Largest audience	Growth potential	Secondary channel
JYSK	Promotion-focused	Limited presence	Low activity

Leroy Merlin	Strong DIY content	Very strong tutorials	Dominant
Maisons du Monde	Strong aesthetic identity	Moderate growth	Brand storytelling

The benchmark analysis highlights several important strategic differences in how brands use social media platforms.

First, Instagram remains the largest platform in terms of audience size, particularly for visually oriented brands such as IKEA and Maisons du Monde.

Second, TikTok demonstrates the highest engagement potential, with significantly stronger interaction rates compared with Instagram. The platform also allows brands to achieve substantial reach even with relatively small follower bases.

Third, YouTube operates as a specialized content platform, where educational and tutorial-based content strategies tend to outperform purely promotional or inspirational communication.

Each brand therefore occupies a different strategic position across platforms:

- IKEA combines strong audience reach with very high engagement on TikTok.
- JYSK focuses on promotional communication that performs best on Instagram.
- Leroy Merlin dominates educational content formats, particularly on YouTube.
- Maisons du Monde emphasizes aesthetic storytelling with a niche but engaged audience.

5. Strategic Insights

The communication audit and benchmark analysis reveal several important strategic insights.

First, IKEA Spain maintains a strong presence across all major social media platforms, which provides the brand with a solid foundation for consistent digital communication and cross-platform storytelling.

Second, the brand demonstrates particularly strong engagement performance on TikTok, achieving the highest engagement rate among the analysed competitors. This suggests that IKEA's short-form video content aligns well with the platform's entertainment-driven culture and audience expectations.

Third, the benchmark analysis highlights clear platform specialization among competitors. Leroy Merlin focuses on expertise-based educational content, particularly on YouTube, while Maisons du Monde emphasizes visual aesthetics and design-oriented communication. This indicates that successful brands tend to develop distinctive content territories rather than pursuing identical strategies across all platforms.

Finally, the results indicate that TikTok currently offers strong organic visibility and audience interaction potential. The platform's combination of high engagement levels and substantial video reach suggests that it represents an important opportunity for brands seeking to strengthen audience interaction and cultural relevance.

6. Platform Selection for Content Strategy

Although IKEA Spain maintains an active presence across several social media platforms, not all channels offer the same strategic potential for future development.

Based on the communication audit and benchmark analysis, TikTok emerges as the most promising platform for the development of a new content strategy.

Several factors support this decision.

First, TikTok demonstrates the highest engagement rate among all analysed platforms, with IKEA Spain achieving 4.03% engagement, which is the strongest performance in the benchmark.

Second, the platform generates the highest average video reach, with IKEA content reaching approximately 450,000 views per video, significantly outperforming competitors.

Third, TikTok's short-form video format allows brands to experiment with creative storytelling, humor, trends, and participatory content, which can significantly increase audience interaction and cultural relevance.

For these reasons, this project will focus on developing a TikTok content strategy aimed at strengthening IKEA Spain's digital visibility and engagement among younger audiences.